



free will
and
determinism

A large orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, containing the text 'against compatibilist free will' in white, bold, sans-serif font.

**against
compatibilist
free will**

against
incompatibilist
free will

We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the reality of free will.

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.
 2. If Libertarianism is true, then there is no free will.
-

C. There is no free will.

The master argument against the reality of free will

A compatibility believer in free will rejects premise (1). An incompatibilist believer in free will rejects premise (2).

This is the consequence argument.

Now that we have a grip on determinism and on one view of free will which would arguably be compatible with determinism, let's look at the central argument against the view that free will is compatible with determinism.

One way to present this argument starts with two very plausible premises.

No one has any choice about the
state of the world in the
distant past.

No one has any choice
about what the laws of
nature are.

Last time, we talked about the idea that we might now have a choice about some past facts — for example, you might have a choice now about whether the belief your roommate formed yesterday about what you would do today was true.

But, even if this were correct, this would not seem to extend to the present case. It seems very clear that I do not now have a choice about the physical state of the universe thousands of years ago.

It also seems very plausible that the laws of nature are not, in any
sense, up to me.

And it seems clear that if I don't have any choice about the above facts, I also don't have any choice about their combination.

We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the

reality of free will.



happened in the distant past.

and none has any choice about whether,

~ If none has about choice about whether P,

choice about DECISION (2, 6, 7)



6. If $\det A$ is true, then A has any

of interest.

nature say that if DINS ARE happy,

varlatatie + the last of the

2. None has any choice about DIDS. ATJR.

5. No one has any choice about what the laws

4. If determinism is true, the laws of

1. No one has any choice about events which

future is not as it was with the state of the



C. If determinist is true, then no one has any

then DECISION happens. (3)

3. If determined, the only one

theorie about the fact that if DNR

about whether @.

if P , then Q , then one has any choice

then DECISION. (4,5)

combination of four - that No

choice about the laws of nature, then no

This argument seems to show that the

one has any choice about the past, no

choice principle, and determinism

rules out free will.

true, there are no free actions — and

Since the first three of these theses



seem quite plausible, the argument

seems to show that if determinism is

hence that free will is incompatible with





The master argument against the reality of free will

Compatibility believer in free will rejects premise (1). An incompatibilist

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central argument against the view that free will is compatible with



deterrinism.

Now that we have a grip on determinism and on our view of free will

which arguably be compatible with determinism, let's look at the

One way to present this argument starts with every plausible premise.



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started the world in the



distasteful.



in vivo and in vitro.

about what the laws of

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Real/|the master argument:

in free will, and find the consequent argument persuasive, it looks

The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe

tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).

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free will

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against
incompatibilist
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 2. If Libertarianism is true, then there is no free will.
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C. There is no free will.

The master argument against the reality of free will

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise (2)

for (2), and one for (3).

or premise (3) is true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one



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